Renaissance

After the Middle Ages, Europe experienced the birth of the Renaissance in Italy. This time saw the arrival of humanism, which meant there were a lot of personal achievements made by people in numerous subjects. The early promoters of this new philosophy, including Francesco Petrarch, drew inspiration from the Ancient Greek and Roman works. It was a combination of ideas from Plato and Socrates with only some concepts derived from Catholicism. Because this philosophy was being pushed forward heavily, the arts and literature fields went through substantial change.

The Renaissance was born in Italy but it quickly paved its way throughout Europe. Many Italian politicians, officials and traders were great supporters of the artists and provided financial support when necessary. Many houses and estates were decorated with impressive pieces of artwork. Out of all the city states, the strongest and most influential were Milan, Florence, Venice and the Papal States.

The different states all had their own unique characters, mainly because they had their own forms of government that ruled over them. The Renaissance is generally accepted amongst scholars to have been initiated in Florence where merchants grew rich by trading wool. The city remained wealthy throughout many years because of the influential Medici family. It was this family that ran the state and maintained the city’s finances wisely.

In Rome, the Pope ruled both the state and the Church. Because of this, the Pope effectively became an international politician and intermediary between the rulers of the various city states. It is stated by some scholars that many popes became corrupted because of their intervention in worldly matters, when they should have been solely focused on Church governance. Rome, which had suffered tremendously during the Middle Ages, became increasingly progressive because of the Renaissance.

Milan and Venice were also incredibly wealthy cities during the Renaissance and contributed greatly to politics. Artists from all over the world found themselves attracted to these beautiful cities. The artist would